

Robert Farrow

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This CV 

Professional Experience

2024 Nov - Present

Visa - Senior Engineering Manager

- Senior Engineering Manager within VXBS (Visa Cross-Border Solutions), leading two teams: RTDP — the team making event-driven architecture happen across the platform — and TRLM, who are rebuilding the core treasury system. Transitioned from data engineering leadership into software engineering leadership and continuing to deliver at pace.
- Founded and run the internal Claude Guild — a cross-team practice of 300+ engineers with monthly demo sessions topping 150 attendees — driving adoption of the latest from Claude, lifting engineering productivity and embedding safe, effective LLM use across VXBS.
- Led the team through our eventification / event-driven architecture pivot, taking Apache Flink from zero to production as the streaming backbone for VXBS — re-architected an external-facing API on top of Flink and Elasticsearch and cut p99 latency significantly, with further rollout ongoing.
- Operate within a regulated Java / Spring Boot stack under strict security controls, delivering services to 5 to 7 nines of availability through fully automated Argo CD and Jenkins pipelines.
- Balance hands-on technical leadership with people management — setting direction, unblocking engineers and owning outcomes, while staying close enough to the stack to make credible technical and architectural decisions.

 Java
 Spring Boot
 Apache Flink
 Kafka
 Elasticsearch
 Kubernetes
 Argo CD
 Jenkins
 AWS
 Claude / LLMs
 Git

2022 Nov - 2024 Nov

Profusion - Head of Engineering

- Led and managed the engineering team end-to-end — hiring, onboarding, performance managing and making the hard calls rather than the easy ones.
- Owned engineering budgets and accounting structure, driving the transition from a loss-making unit to the leading revenue generator for the business.
- Designed and rolled out a utilisation model to identify and fix pipeline inefficiencies, upskilling project management on the process and sustaining the 70%+ billable zone needed for consultancy profitability.
- Set strategic direction — technology choices, skills redundancy, AWS partnership — while fostering a continuous-learning culture; communicated direction internally and externally via blog posts such as [the machine that builds the machine](#).
- Built a reusable Terraform IAC framework for AWS account management — VPC, VPN, IAM, budgeting, alerting and endpoint management — underpinning a new multi-client, multi-account delivery model.